

CORPUS CHRISTI (OPTIONAL) SEQUENCE: LAUDA SION

Zion, praise your Saviour.

Praise your leader and shepherd in hymns and canticles.

Praise him as much as you can, for he is beyond all praising
and you will never be able to praise him as he merits.

But today a theme worthy of particular praise
is put before us — the living and life- giving bread
that, without any doubt,

was given to the Twelve at table during the holy supper.

Therefore let our praise be full and resounding
and our soul's rejoicing full of delight and beauty,
for this is the festival day

to commemorate the first institution of this table.

At this table of the new King,

the new law's new Pasch puts an end to the old Pasch.

The new displaces the old, reality the shadow and light the darkness.

Christ wanted what he did at the supper
to be repeated in his memory.

And so we, in accordance with his holy directions
consecrate bread and wine to be salvation's Victim.

Christ's followers know by faith that bread is changed into his flesh
and wine into his blood.

Man cannot understand this, cannot perceive it;
but a lively faith affirms that the change,
which is outside the natural course of things, takes place.

Under the different species,
which are now signs only and not their own reality,
there lie hid wonderful realities. His body is our food, his blood our
And yet Christ remains entire under each species.

The communicant receives the complete Christ —
uncut, unbroken and undivided.

Whether one receive or a thousand,
the one receives as much as the thousand.
Nor is Christ diminished by being received.
The good and the wicked alike receive him,
but with the unlike destiny of life or death.
To the wicked it is death, but life to the good.
See how different is the result,
though each receives the same.
Last of all, if the sacrament is broken, have no doubt.
Remember there is as much in a fragment as in an unbroken host.
There is no division of the reality, but only a breaking of the sign;
nor does the breaking diminish the condition or size
of the One hidden under the sign.

* Behold, the bread of angels is become the pilgrim's food;
truly it is bread for the sons, and is not to be cast to dogs.
It was prefigured in type when Isaac was brought as an offering,
when a lamb was appointed for the Pasch
and when manna was given to the Jews of old.
Jesus, good shepherd and true bread, have mercy on us;
feed us and guard us.

Grant that we find happiness in the land of the living.
You know all things, can do all things, and feed us here on earth.
Make us your guests in heaven,
co-heirs with you and companions of heaven's citizens.

Amen. Alleluia. ALLELUIA John 6:51

Alleluia. I am the living bread which came down from heaven, says the
Lord; if any one eats this bread he will live for ever. Alleluia.